reserved for women, two each for SCs and for OBCs at ‘every level’ of the party.

January 2017: Modi government launches PM Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY) for pregnant women not employed by any Central or state government for direct-cash benefits from the state for the first time.

- 15.4 million pregnant women enrolled for maternity cash transfers as part of this scheme between 2017 and 2020.
- Of these, 13.8 million women received cash benefits. They each received payments of ₹4,138 on average in their bank accounts.
- Government amends the Maternity Act in 2017 to increase maternity leave for women working in establishments with over ten employees from the earlier requirement of twelve weeks to twenty-six weeks.

April 2016–September 2019: The Ujjwala scheme, which provided over 80 million free LPG connections between April 2016–September 2019, could only be availed by women under the poverty line who also received direct cash transfers of up to ₹1,600 each.

2019: Women accounted for 48.08 per cent of Indian voters in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls; 67.18 per cent of women voters cast their vote in 2019—on par with the overall voting percentage of 67.4 per cent—and higher than the male turnout rate of 67 per cent. In other words, women voters voted as much as men voters did in 2019.

2014–2020: Modi’s two governments (NDA-1 and NDA-2) gave slightly higher proportional representation to women ministers (12.7 per cent average) compared to Manmohan Singh’s two previous ones (11.2 per cent average in UPA-1 and UPA-2), and significantly higher than Vajpayee’s previous BJP-led NDA government.

2019: BJP fields more women than any other political party in India, with fifty-five female candidates. It narrowly pipped the Congress, which fielded fifty-four women. In proportional representation terms, the BJP’s share of women candidates (12.6 per cent) is marginally behind the Congress (12.8 per cent).